

TEACHING TIPS:

- There are lots of words in this song that all need to be sung clearly, so **start with a warm-up that focuses on diction** such as *Peter Piper* from *Sing Warm-Ups*.
- There is lots of nice easy stepwise movement in this melody, but the occasional semitones will need practice, e.g. notice the difference between the notes of the first 'It's a good' in bar 4 and the 'it's a good' in bar 8.
- Help the children to know when to come in at the end of the first time bar. Listen out for two upbeats in the brass and then come in with 'It's a' on the third one.

WHAT YOU NEED

A good sense of pulse

LOOK

There are some amazing examples of body percussion to watch online. Try looking up **THE PERCUSSION SHOW** body percussion on YouTube for starters.

RHYTHM



Pulse – the beat, or steady heartbeat of the music

Rest – a period of silence of a specified duration

Call & response – a musical phrase in which the first melody or rhythm is responded to or echoed by another melody or rhythm

BRIGHT IDEA



In a circle, tapping the pulse on the knees, all sing 'It's a good time to tell you, I love you Mum'. Now replace 'you Mum' with other words suggested by the children such as **'baked beans', 'football', 'my dog'** etc. They'll need to think of two-syllable phrases. Do a few together to get the idea. Then go around the circle and point to a volunteer (sitting with their hand raised) who would like to sing their suggestion while everyone else keeps the pulse going. This game encourages confidence and singing in time.

WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?



- To keep a steady pulse.
- To explore rests in music.
- To listen to a rhythm and clap it back (call and response).
- To begin to sing confidently and in time.

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

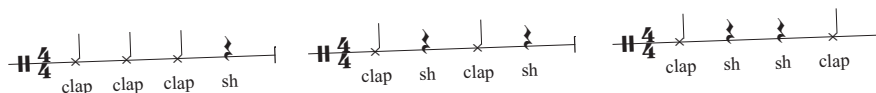
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First, listen to the song and feel its strong **four-beat pulse** by clapping or tapping along, saying **1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4** with emphasis on the 1 each time (perhaps add a stamp on this beat).

Now, listen carefully to the melody line. Explain that a **rest** is a period of silence in a piece of music (not a time for lying down!). **Can the class identify where there are rests in the music?** To demonstrate this, say 'sh' with a finger to the lips in each of the rests. Sometimes there will be one 'sh' (a one-beat rest e.g. after 'I love you Mum' and 'you're the best') and sometimes two (a two-beat rest e.g. after 'best mum for me!').

Sitting or standing in a circle, have half the class keeping the pulse steady by tapping their knees. Clap some four-beat rhythms with rests in, for the other half of the class to copy. Then swap over groups. For example:



With older or more confident pupils, each could clap their response individually. Can the children say which beat of the bar the rest was on? Would one pupil like to lead by clapping a 'rest rhythm' for the others to copy?